



The original Viper used lethal poison-tipped throwing darts to carve out a criminal career.

VIPER

Her face scarred at some point in her nebulous past, the woman who would one day be known as Viper began her career as a member of the international terrorist organization called HYDRA. After the leadership of Hydra was captured by NICK FURY and SHIELD, she assumed command of the remnants of the organization and, as MADAME HYDRA, excelled at creating panic and terror until CAPTAIN AMERICA brought her down. Madame Hydra later resurfaced in Virginia, where she murdered Jordan Stryke, a costumed criminal known as Viper, as he was being escorted by US marshals to Washington DC to testify about his criminal connections. She stole his costume and, assuming his name, took command of the Serpent Squad he had assembled. Under the new Viper's leadership, the Serpent Squad became a terrorist

unit. Since then, both alone or in concert with allies such as the SILVER SAMURAI, BARON STRUCKER and the RED SKULL, Viper has continued to hatch plans resulting in chaos and anarchy. She is normally connected as a lover to the SILVER SAMURAI although she once forced WOLVERINE to marry her. (It didn't last.) For a while, Viper ran the nation of Madripoor as its dictator, but SHIELD and IRON MAN overthrew her. A third Viper recently surfaced as part of SIN's new Serpent Squad, but little about him is yet known. **TB, MF**



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Unrevealed

OCCUPATION

Terrorist

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 9 ins

WEIGHT Unknown

EYES Green

HAIR Black with green highlights

FIRST APPEARANCE

Captain America #110
(February 1969)

Viper is a superb strategist and a trained terrorist with extensive knowledge of weaponry, tactics, and fighting styles. She is skilled in a number of martial arts and an expert in the use of various weapons, including whips.

VIPER

POWERS

VIRGO

FIRST APPEARANCE Avengers #72 (January 1970)

REAL NAME Elaine McLaughlin

OCCUPATION Professional criminal

BASE Denver, Colorado

HEIGHT 5 ft 6 in **WEIGHT** 125 lbs **EYES** Green **HAIR** Red

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Sharp criminal mind; good organizer; a skilled hand-to-hand combatant.



Gang boss Virgo was recruited to be a member of Cornelius Van Lunt's ZODIAC crime cartel, in which each member would adopt the guise of a different sign of the zodiac, and control a territory in a different American city. Zodiac was equipped with state-of-the-art weaponry and their ultimate goal was global domination.

However, their bid for power was foiled by the combined forces of SHIELD and the

AVENGERS. Later, a rogue Zodiac faction led by former Cartel member SCORPIO and using androids to represent the twelve zodiacological symbols targeted the original Zodiac leaders for death. In the end, Virgo was slain by her robot counterpart. **TB**

VON DOOM, CYNTHIA

FIRST APPEARANCE Astonishing Tales #8 (October 1971)

REAL NAME Cynthia von Doom

OCCUPATION Sorceress **BASE** Astral plane

HEIGHT 5 ft 8 in **WEIGHT** 150 lbs **EYES** Brown **HAIR** Brown

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Knowledge of magic allowed her to contact demons; however she often unleashed forces that it was beyond her abilities to control.

Cynthia von Doom was a sorceress who belonged to a group of Latverian gypsies called the Zefiro. She married Werner von Doom, a healer. Their son Victor grew up to become DOCTOR DOOM. Cynthia summoned the demon MEPHISTO, who offered her great power so she could overthrow Latveria's ruthless king and give her people a homeland. She unleashed terrible magic but could not control it. One of the king's guards killed her, and her soul joined Mephisto in Hell. After Cynthia's death, young Victor found his mother's trunk of magic paraphernalia. Every year since he has tried to summon her back from Mephisto's realm. **AD**



VON BLITZSCHLAG, BARON

FIRST APPEARANCE Avengers: The Initiative #1 (April 2007)

REAL NAME Werner von Blitzschlag

OCCUPATION Scientist **BASE** Camp Hammond

HEIGHT 5 ft 10 in **WEIGHT** 165 lbs **EYES** Gray **HAIR** Gray

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Genius who can produce and control electricity.

During World War II, von Blitzschlag worked as a scientist for the Nazis. After the war, he disappeared until he became the head of research for The Fifty-State Initiative (see pp. 118-9), working at Camp Hammond. After the death of Michael VAN PATRICK, von Blitzschlag cloned the young man many times, producing the SCARLET SPIDERS and KIA. KIA's attack left the old man bound to a wheelchair and stuck on life support. When THOR's clone later tried to kill him with lightning, the attack strengthened von Blitzschlag instead. Von Blitzschlag still works at Camp Hammond, and he treats the clones he's created as sons.

MF

